

FOSSIL HORSE TRADING

The following confidential memorandum from the archives of the American Museum of Natural History provides details on some of the exchanges that brought the widely dispersed Barosaurus skeleton to the American Museum:

REPORT ON BAROSAURUS

Supplementing my report of July 26, 1929, I again visited Salt Lake City in December and secured the following agreement from Dr. [Frederick J.] Pack who has authority from the President and Trustees of the University to act in their behalf in this negotiation.

Value of specimen agreed upon \$5000. Terms \$2,500 in cash, balance in trade.

Specimens desired by University of Utah: a three-toed horse skeleton (we can supply a composite skeleton), and other mammal material to make up difference. American Museum to box, ship and pay transportation charges on *Barosaurus*.

This agreement I consider fair with full value coming to the American Museum providing we can secure the remainder of this skeleton.

The part of this *Barosaurus* skeleton in the National Museum consists of the last ten cervical vertebrae with

ribs; three anterior dorsals; left scapula and humerus. It has cost \$3,400 to clean and restore it (Laboratory records).

[Charles W.] Gilmore (confidentially) favors an exchange and desires a free mountable skeleton of *Gorgosaurus*. Dr. [Alexander] Wetmore does not favor disposal of this *Barosaurus* neck (from conversation reported by Gilmore).

American Museum can offer the following specimen in exchange: *Gorgosaurus* No. 5434. Skull and jaws, all cervicals, and dorsal vertebrae, all ribs, forelimbs, one femur. Sacrum, hind limbs, except one femur, will be cast.

Cost of preparing and casting hind limbs and part of tail \$4,123. To finish tail and sacrum \$450.—total cost \$4,573. (Cost taken from Laboratory time sheets and exclusive of collecting and transportation charges).

The caudal series of this skeleton nine or ten vertebrae in the Carnegie Museum are preserved in two blocks, 348/A and 349/B according to their quarry charts.

So far no negotiations have been undertaken to secure this part of the specimen.

A.M.N.H.
Dec. 31, 1929

Barnum Brown

AMNH



Bone collector Barnum Brown and his wife, Lilian, at Howe Quarry in 1934